Diagnostics guide - Llama Desktop Launcher

Version 0.9.0 · English

This guide helps you find out why something did not work: where to look, what the app's messages mean, common problems for each engine and platform, and how to build a report when asking for help. For normal use, see the **User manual** (MANUAL-en); for clients and the API, the **Integration guide** (INTEGRATION-en).

The app interface is in Portuguese, so messages are quoted in Portuguese with their meaning in English.

1. Where to start

1. **Read the message** shown below the buttons (red when it is an error). The most common ones are in section 10.
2. **Open the Registro do motor** (engine log) on the **Llama** screen (accordion below the buttons). It shows the engine output and [launcher] lines describing what the app tried to do. The last lines before a failure usually give the cause: not enough memory, incompatible file, busy port, missing driver.
3. **Copy the diagnostic report** in **Settings > 06 · Diagnóstico** (section 3) if you will ask for help.

The log lives **in memory only** while the launcher is open: the window shows the last 30,000 characters and the report takes the last 12,000. There is no log file on disk. Copy the report **before** closing the app.

2. Where data is stored

System	App data folder
Windows	%APPDATA%\Llama Desktop Launcher
Linux	~/.config/Llama Desktop Launcher
macOS	~/Library/Application Support/Llama Desktop Launcher

Item	Location
Preferences, folders and profiles	settings.json in the data folder
Permanent API key	server-api-key.txt in the data folder (never send it to anyone)
Downloaded llama.cpp	engines/ in the data folder, one subfolder per download
vLLM on Linux	engines/vllm-0.32.0-… in the data folder (or the environment you chose)
vLLM on Windows	The vllm/vllm-openai:v0.32.0 image in Docker Desktop; llama-desktop-vllm-… containers
Strata / PolyStrata	The folder where their installer ran
Update packages	updates/ in the data folder
Models	The folders chosen in **02 · Pastas**

Each engine's path is also shown in **Settings**. If settings.json is corrupted, the app falls back to the default configuration and overwrites the file. Make a copy before editing it by hand.

3. Diagnostic report

In **Settings > 06 · Diagnóstico**, click **Copiar relatório de diagnóstico** (Copy diagnostic report). The text goes to the clipboard and is shown right below the button for you to review.

The report contains:

- launcher, Electron and Node versions, operating system and architecture;
- detected CPU, RAM, GPU and VRAM;
- each engine's state (ready, pending or unavailable), version, mode and path, plus the llama.cpp backend and release and the Docker state on Windows;
- model folders (and whether they exist), model count per engine, the selected model and its profile;
- chosen address and sessions, the running server (engine, port, model ID, context, sharing);
- update check state;
- the last 12,000 characters of the engine log.

Before copying, the app **removes** the permanent API key, the sharing credential, Bearer headers, token= parameters, variables such as *_API_KEY and *_TOKEN, Hugging Face tokens (hf_…), and replaces your home folder with ~. Even so, **read the text before sending it**: model names, local network IPs and prompt fragments in the log remain visible.

To ask for help, open a GitHub issue with the report, what you did and what you expected. Never post the API key or links with access.

If the app does not open

Build the report by hand: system and version, launcher version (installer name), how you installed it (EXE, DEB, RPM, AppImage, DMG) and the message shown. On Linux, start it from a terminal (llama-desktop-launcher or the AppImage) to see error output. If the problem started after editing settings.json, rename the file and open the app again.

4. General problems

Symptom	What to do
The model list is empty	Check the folders in **02 · Pastas** and click **Atualizar lista**. GGUF files must end in .gguf; vLLM needs config.json and .safetensors in the same folder; Strata needs its installed folder chosen in **01B**.
The app always opens in Settings	A ready engine, a model in the folders or a selected model is missing. Select a model on the **Llama** screen or click **Concluir e ir para Llama**.
Start buttons are disabled	The selected model's engine is not ready (see the badge in **Settings**) or something is already running. Stop the server, chat or benchmark.
“Conversar aqui” and “Abrir CLI” are disabled	They are for GGUF on llama.cpp only. With vLLM or Strata, use **Iniciar servidor** and a client.
The model folder is rejected	It cannot be inside the installation or inside the app data folder.
GPU or VRAM shows as “não medida” (not measured)	The system did not report a reliable value. Suggestions use RAM only; adjust by hand.

5. llama.cpp

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
Engine download fails	No internet, no space, or GitHub blocked. Try again or use **Escolher pasta existente** with an engine downloaded by hand.
“A versão … não contém todos os pacotes de …”	The release lacks that backend for your platform. Choose another backend.
“Checksum SHA-256 do download não confere” (checksum mismatch)	Corrupted or intercepted download. Try again on another network.
“O pacote CUDA não contém as bibliotecas esperadas” / “Pacote baixado sem llama-server”	The release layout changed. Choose another backend or an existing folder and report it.
“O motor encerrou antes de ficar pronto.” (engine exited before ready)	Check the end of the engine log. Usually: not enough memory (lower context, batch or GPU layers, or use q8_0 cache), GGUF incompatible with b12211, missing shards or missing driver.
“Tempo esgotado ao carregar o modelo.” (load timed out)	llama.cpp has 5 minutes to load. Use a smaller model, a faster disk or less context.
The GPU is not used	Check the backend (CUDA for NVIDIA, Vulkan for any GPU), the driver and the **GPU layers** field (auto or all). The log shows how many layers went to the GPU.
CUDA does not load on Windows	Update the NVIDIA driver. If it persists, try the Vulkan backend.
“Este pacote não inclui llama-bench.” / benchmark fails	Use an official package with llama-bench or more conservative settings. The test is limited to 10 minutes.
“Não encontrei um terminal gráfico.” (Linux)	Install a terminal such as gnome-terminal or xterm to use **Abrir CLI no terminal**.
“Este pacote do llama.cpp não inclui llama-fit-params.”	Old or incomplete package. Download the official engine again. Without it, automatic values are not shown, but the server works.
Autotuning: attempt with “não coube na memória” (did not fit in memory) or “failed to allocate”	Expected: that combination exceeds the GPU limit and was dropped. The result uses the ones that fit.
Autotuning: “Divisão entre GPUs: row” fails	The backend (Vulkan, for example) does not support -sm row. The attempt is dropped.
Autotuning changes little or nothing	A value replaces the current one only with a gain of at least 2%. With a short budget the search stops before testing everything; the **Medições do autotuning** table shows what was tested.
“Este modelo não tem camadas MTP (draft-mtp).”	The GGUF has no NextN/MTP layers. Pick another speculative decoding type or leave it on Auto.
“Cache V quantizado exige Flash Attention ligado ou automático.”	Turn Flash Attention on or use an f16 V cache.
“Escolha o modelo rascunho para a decodificação especulativa.”	The draft-simple and draft-eagle3 types need a smaller GGUF of the same family in your model folders.
A field appears under “Não se aplicam a este modelo”	The reason is shown below it. If the launcher cannot read the GGUF header, nothing is hidden.

6. vLLM

Linux (Python environment)

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
“Python 3 não encontrado.”	Install python3 and python3-venv (Python 3.10 to 3.13), e.g. sudo apt install python3 python3-venv.
“python falhou (1): …” during install	pip failed; the end of the message and the log show why (network, space, Python version without a wheel). The incomplete folder is deleted; try again.
“A pasta precisa conter bin/vllm.”	In **Usar ambiente existente**, choose the environment root (the folder that contains bin/).
CUDA error or “no GPU” on start	The pip package is NVIDIA-only. Check nvidia-smi. For AMD, install vLLM with ROCm from the official docs and point to that environment.
GPU out of memory	Lower **Context** (--max-model-len) and **Simultaneous sessions** (--max-num-seqs), or use a quantized model (AWQ, GPTQ).

Windows (Docker Desktop)

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
“Docker Desktop não encontrado ou parado.”	Install Docker Desktop with WSL2, open it, wait until it is ready and click **Verificar de novo**.
The image pull fails	It needs about 10 GB free on the WSL disk and a stable connection. Try again; docker pull resumes.
The container does not see the GPU	Enable GPU support in WSL2 following the Docker documentation and update the Windows NVIDIA driver.
“Os pesos deste modelo são links simbólicos…” (weights are symlinks)	The folder points to files outside it. Use a folder with the real files or the Hugging Face cache layout (models--org--name/snapshots/<hash>).
“O caminho do modelo não pode conter vírgulas…” (no commas in path)	Rename the folder or move the model to a path without commas.
The model asks to download or a file is missing	The container runs offline (HF_HUB_OFFLINE=1). Download the complete repository (including the tokenizer) first.
A container is left running	Run docker ps --filter name=llama-desktop-vllm- and docker stop NAME.
Network clients cannot connect	The automatic firewall rule does not cover Docker; create the manual rule from the Integration guide.
“O número de GPUs (N) precisa dividir as … cabeças de atenção do modelo.”	Choose a tensor parallelism that divides the number of heads (1, 2, 4…).
vLLM autotuning: the fp8 attempt fails	The GPU does not accept an fp8 KV cache; the attempt is dropped.
vLLM autotuning takes very long	Each attempt reloads the model and captures CUDA graphs. Choose 20 or 30 minutes, or tune by hand after the initial suggestion.

vLLM can take several minutes on the first load. The launcher waits up to 30 minutes before showing “Tempo esgotado ao carregar o modelo.”.

7. Strata and PolyStrata

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
“A pasta precisa ser uma instalação do Strata ou do PolyStrata já configurada…”	Choose the installation root, which contains serve/server.py and .venv. If .venv is missing, run their START-HERE.bat or setup.sh to the end.
The folder is accepted but no model appears	The launcher only reads strata-*.json at the folder root and ignores *.shared-settings.json, files over 1 MB and invalid JSON. Configure a model with their installer.
Simultaneous sessions change nothing	PolyStrata uses the parallel value from its own config; change it there.
The server exits or never gets ready	Check the log: usually the weights were not downloaded, the GPU is not supported or memory ran out. Test the server with the project's own tools to isolate the problem.
“Não foi possível localizar o Python base do Strata / PolyStrata (pyvenv.cfg)…”	The .venv does not point to an existing Python. Recreate the environment with their installer or open the port in the firewall manually.
The client says the model does not exist	Use the **Modelo API** from the panel (the config's model_name), not modelo-local. Copy the setup again.
A Strata field disabled with “A versão instalada … não aceita --…”	The installed serve/server.py lacks that option. Update through the project's installer.

8. Network, keys and firewall

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
The LAN or Tailscale address is not listed	Only private IPv4 and Tailscale (100.64.0.0/10) addresses are listed. Make sure Tailscale is connected and reopen the launcher.
Works on this PC but not on another	Firewall, wrong IP or different network. Test GET /v1/models from the other computer (examples in the Integration guide).
“Acesso negado: chave ou token de sessão local ausente ou inválido.”	The local bridge page was opened without its token. Use **Abrir no navegador** again.
“Acesso compartilhado ausente, expirado ou revogado.”	The shared link is from a previous run or was revoked. Copy a new one.
401 on the direct port	Wrong key, or it was replaced with **Nova chave**. Copy the current key.
“A faixa de clientes precisa conter o endereço da rede selecionada.”	Use a range that includes the server IP, such as 192.168.1.0/24 for 192.168.1.5.
“O endereço remoto deve ficar dentro de uma rede LAN privada ou Tailscale.”	The rule only accepts 10/8, 172.16/12, 192.168/16 or 100.64/10.
“As regras não foram removidas: a autorização de administrador foi negada…” (rules not removed)	The administrator prompt was denied or closed. Click **Remover regras do launcher** again and accept.
The firewall rule is not created	The administrator prompt was denied or closed. Click again and accept.
Old rules are still open	LlamaDesktopLauncher-… rules stay in Windows after the server stops. For Strata/PolyStrata they allow the system-wide python.exe, used by every Python program. Use **Settings > 07 · Firewall do Windows > Remover regras do launcher**, wf.msc or, in an administrator PowerShell, Get-NetFirewallRule -Name 'LlamaDesktopLauncher-*' | Remove-NetFirewallRule.
“ID de modelo inválido.” when copying	The Strata model_name is empty, longer than 128 characters, starts with - or contains a line break or another control character. Spaces and symbols are accepted. Fix the name in the strata-*.json config.

9. Updates

Symptom	Likely cause and fix
“Você já usa a versão mais recente” (you are up to date) but a new one exists	The check runs at startup and once a day. Click **Verificar agora**.
The check fails	No access to api.github.com (network, proxy or rate limit). Try later or download from the releases page.
“Esta versão não tem pacote para este sistema.”	The release has no installer for your platform. Use the release notes to download another format.
“SHA256SUMS.txt não lista o pacote…” / “Checksum … não confere”	The package was deleted for safety. Try again; if it repeats, report it.

10. App messages

Message	Meaning
“Pare a execução atual antes de iniciar outra.”	A server, chat, benchmark or engine setup is already running.
“Instale ou selecione o llama.cpp primeiro.”	The model is GGUF and llama.cpp is not ready.
“Prepare o vLLM em Configurações primeiro.”	vLLM is not installed (Linux) or the image is not pulled (Windows).
“Escolha a pasta do Strata ou do PolyStrata em Configurações primeiro.”	The model belongs to Strata, but the folder is not set or no longer valid.
“… está disponível só para modelos GGUF no llama.cpp.”	Integrated chat, CLI, analysis and automatic values (llama-fit-params) exist only for llama.cpp.
“O Strata e o PolyStrata não têm autotuning…”	Quantization, context and GPU come from their installer's configuration.
“Já existe um teste em execução.”	Wait, or click **Cancelar** in autotuning.
“Modelo não encontrado nas pastas configuradas.”	The file moved or the folder changed. Refresh the list.
“Escolha um endereço de rede disponível.”	The chosen IP no longer exists (network changed). Choose again.
“Pare o servidor antes de gerar outra chave.”	The key cannot change while the server runs.
“Inicie o servidor em LAN ou Tailscale para compartilhar.”	Sharing does not exist for local access.
“Chave de API inválida. Gere uma nova chave.”	server-api-key.txt was modified. Use **Nova chave**.
“O vLLM no Docker escuta pelo Docker Desktop…”	The automatic rule does not cover Docker; create the manual rule.
“Escolha uma pasta fora da instalação do aplicativo…”	Uninstalling would delete that folder.

11. Before opening an issue

- Update to the latest version and reproduce the problem.
- Reproduce it with the smallest possible model and default settings.
- Copy the diagnostic report right after the failure, before closing the launcher.
- Review the report and remove anything personal.
- Describe the steps, the expected result and what happened.